

Suraj Ganachari

Level 4
2024 - 2025

Let the Right One In

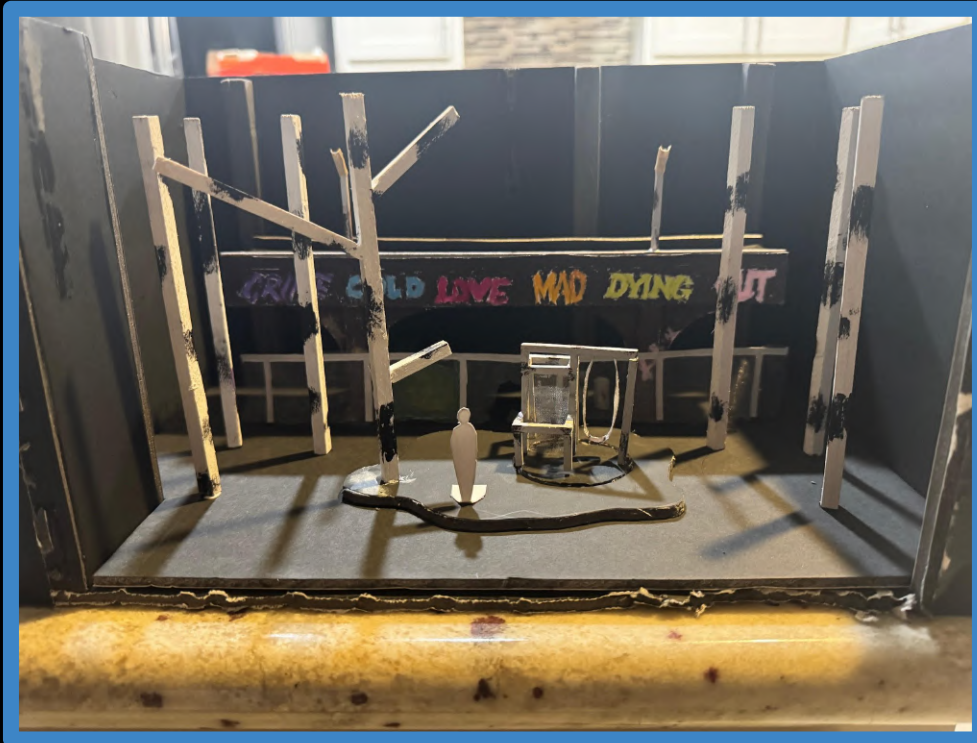


Scenic Designer for HSPVA's
2025 Spring Mainstage:
Let the Right One In

Director: Paul Davis
Lighting Designer: Sam
Mascheck

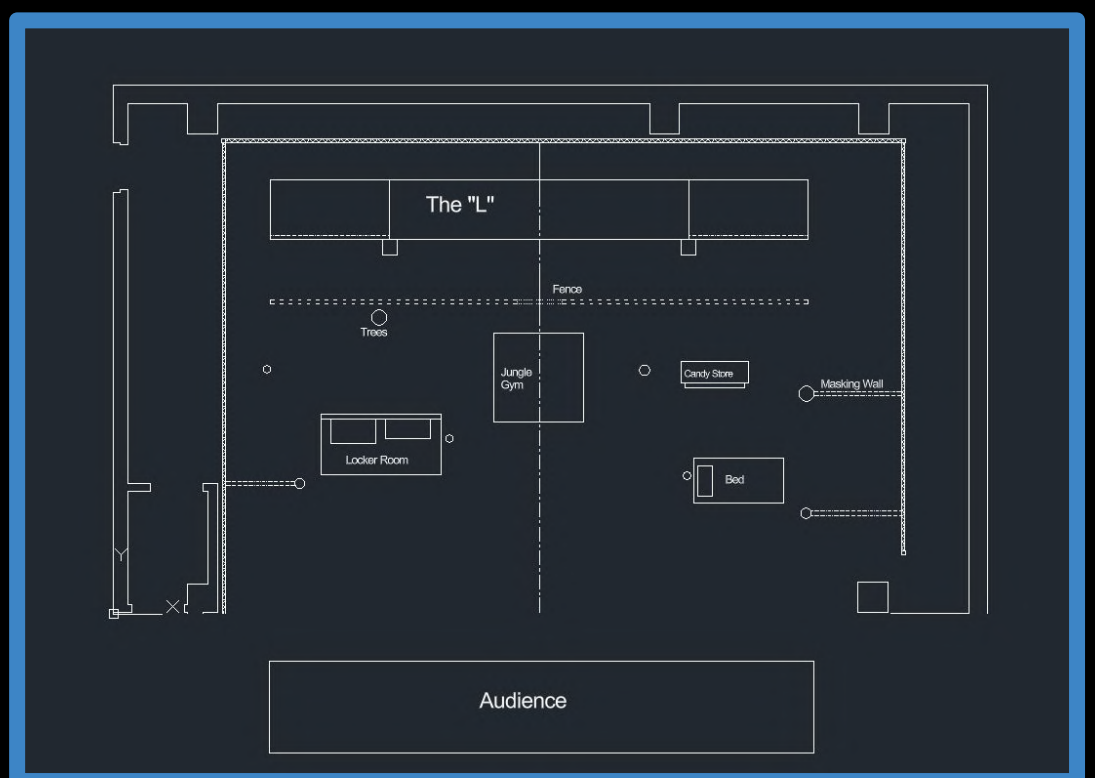


Let the Right One In



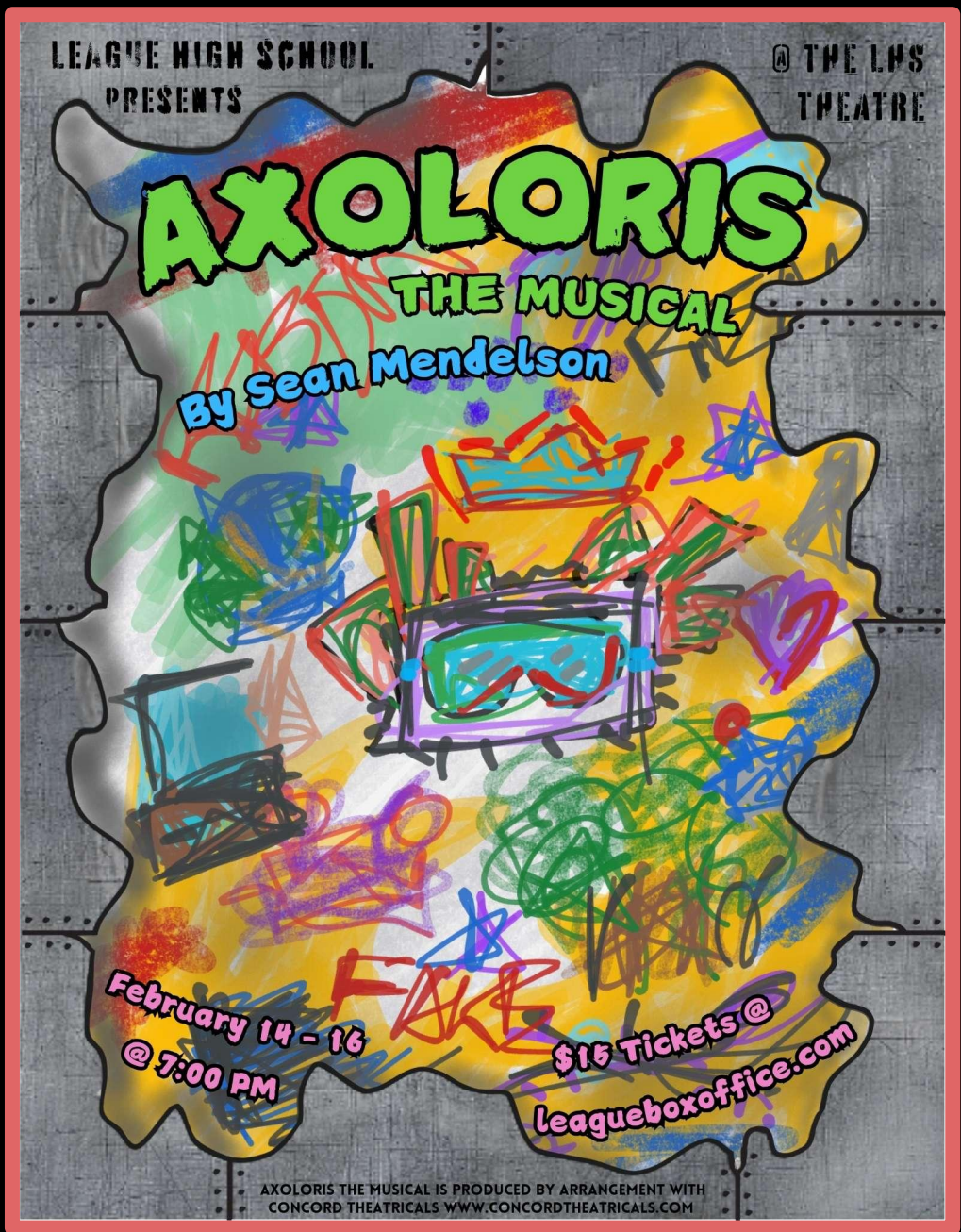
In my original design, I envisioned a **1980s Chicago** vibe with **shadowy** areas upstage beneath the “**L**” overpass. The pool would be behind the **playground unit**, and the Morse code would be shown by lighting specific **graffiti** letters. **Tall trees** would add an **ominous** atmosphere.

I created the **model** above for my initial audition and later **refined** it with the director’s input. I used **AutoCAD** to design the ground plan and sourced many **posters**, creating some myself using **Canva**.



We relied on **projections** to create **atmosphere**, under the guise of a metro station **under construction**. The pool was built behind the **playground unit**, which, along with other rolling units like the lockers, was mounted on **casters**. The playground unit rotated to **reveal the pool**.

UIL Design



With my design, I highlighted the **juxtaposition** between the cold and sterile feel of **industrialism** and the vibrant and natural feel of **postmodernism**. I used **Canva** to create the poster, the marketing calendar, a playbill, and an example post for social media.

This is my submission to the **UIL Theatrical Design competition** which is a statewide design competition. I did an individual submission in the **Marketing** category for **Axoloris the Musical**. My design revolved around the **neo-expressionism** movement of the **1970s**.

2025

MARKETING CALENDAR

DECEMBER

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

JANUARY

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
			1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	29	30	31	

FEBRUARY

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24	25	26	27	28	

AXOLORIS THE MUSICAL

By Sean Mendelson

DECEMBER

12/10 Social Media
•Show Teaser/Reveal

12/15 Finalize & Begin
Printing Posters

12/24 Display Posters

JANUARY

1/14 Social Media
•Designer Spotlight

1/19 Tickets Open to
Public

1/21 Social Media
•Cast Spotlight

1/24 Social Media
•3 Week Countdown

1/28 Social Media
•Director Spotlight

1/31 Social Media
•2 Week Countdown

FEBRUARY

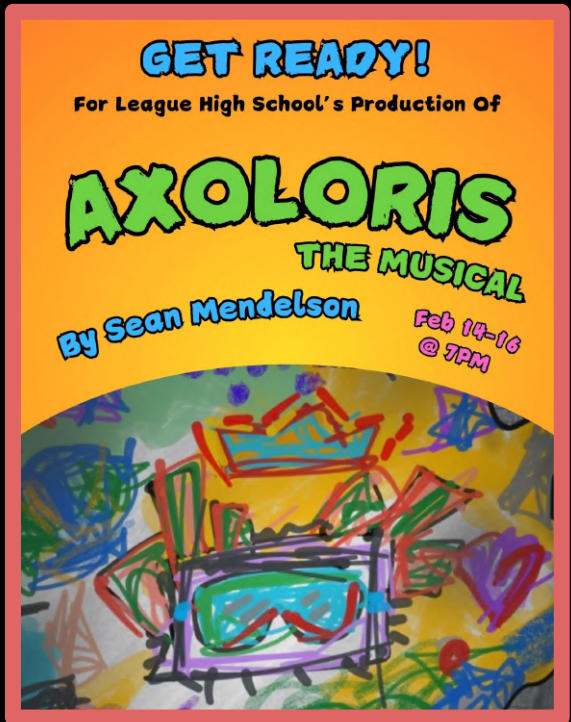
2/2 Finalize Playbill
& Begin Printing

2/4 Social Media
•Designer Takeover

2/7 Social Media
•1 Week Countdown

2/11 Social Media
•Cast Takeover

2/14 Performance
-16 Nights (7PM)



League High School Production Of

AXOLORIS

THE MUSICAL

By Sean Mendelson

Director

PAUL DAVIS

Costume Design

AUTUMN KIMBALL

Scenic Design

HANNAH MALTBIE

Lighting Design

LAYLA HARRIS

Hair/Makeup Design

ISABELLA ALEMAN

Sound Design

LAUREN PHILPOTT

Stage Manager

TOSIE GOLDFARB

Producer

DANA HARRELL

Axoloris The Musical is produced by arrangement with Concord Theatricals

www.concordtheatricals.com

DIRECTOR'S NOTE

This is a coming of age story in the vein of Goonies or Stranger Things. It has science fiction elements because it's the future and leans on Robots and Virtual Reality heavily. It's meant to be fun and uplifting, but there is real pathos in the characters' struggles to self-discovery. There is also an ethereal emphasis on dreams and the unconscious. It breaks the fourth wall with the audience, allowing them to participate in the direction of the story, in a first-of-its-kind, interactive experience. Ultimately, it hopes to inspire families in the audience, just like the characters in the show, to innovate and appreciate Earth on Earth Day and year round.

SETTING

A small community in 2050 near a hydroelectric plant

ACT 1

The township

ACT 2

The hydroelectric plant

Any video and/or audio recording of this production is strictly prohibited.

Please do not bring food or drink into the theatre.

Check out our website leagueboxoffice.com

Follow us @LeagueHighSchool

The Servant of Two Masters

Cue	Scene (Page)	Setting	Line	Emotion	Color	Notes	Research
0	Act - Scene 0 - 0 Page # 0	Preshow Look	The Servant of Two Masters	Party Dark Still	Many	Pulsing Lights Tinges of color Movers spinning around the space	
2	Act - Scene 1 - 1 Page # 2	Pantalone's House	The Servant of Two Masters	Joy Significance Opulence	White Gold	Sconces? Wash	
4	Act - Scene 1 - 1 Page # 4		"I...can't...get up..."	Excitement Silly	Yellow	Circus spotlight? Few secs	

Lighting Designer for HSPVA's
2024 Fall Rep Show:
The Servant of Two Masters

Director: Deborah Hope
Set Designer: Hannah Maltbie

Since this was my **first time** doing lighting design, I took the opportunity to **experiment** with colors and intensities, which made the show very **vibrant**. I also explored using the **cyclorama** to create different moods.



Props



Above is a **tile** I recreated using a piece of **foam**. I carefully carved into the foam with a **precision knife**, using precise measurements to ensure the lines were accurate and the **intricate** details were captured. Then, I painted it meticulously to match the original design.



My partner, Lauren Philpott, and I created a **squirrel puppet** for the 2024 fall All-School Musical, **9 to 5**.

We sculpted the head with **paper-mâché**, carved the body from **foam**, and attached **hinged** arms and legs for movement. We finished it with **patchwork fabric**, beady eyes, a toothy grin, and **dowels** for onstage manipulation.

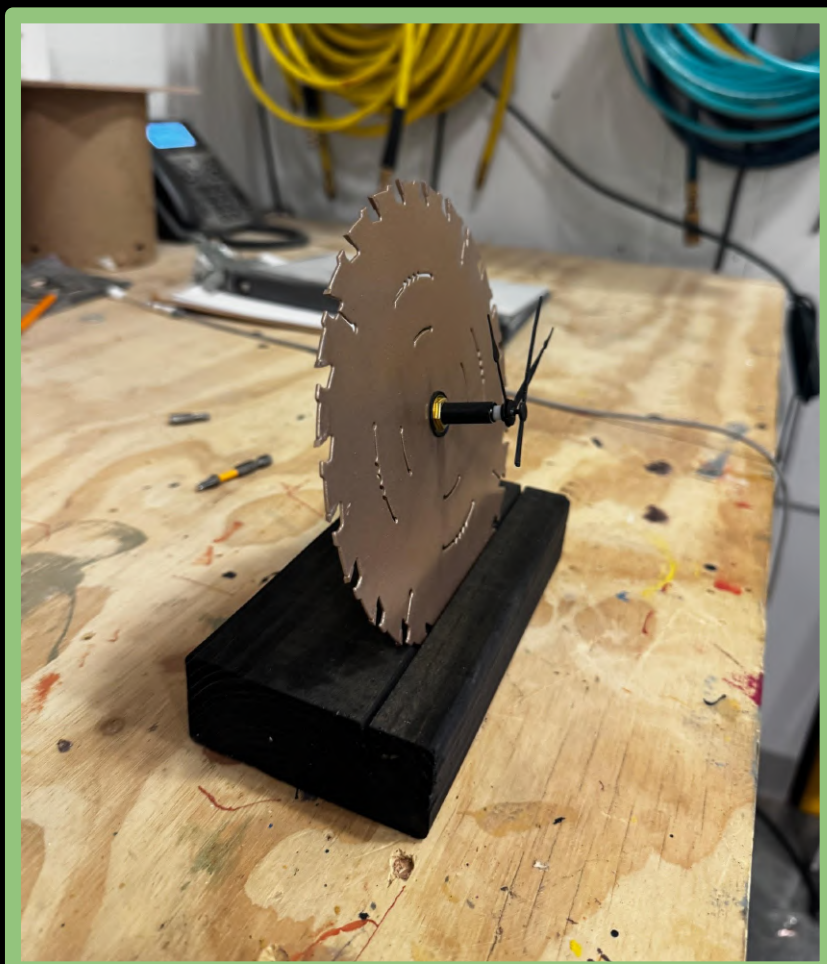
Personal Projects



I repurposed an **old saw blade** to create a functional **clock**. I painted it gold for a bold finish, built a wooden base for support, and installed a **clock mechanism kit** to make it fully operational.



In our prop-making class, we used **alginate** to create molds of our hands. After it set, we filled the mold with **plaster of Paris**. Once dry, we removed the mold to reveal a detailed **hand sculpture**.



Suraj Ganachari

**Level 3
2023 - 2024**

No No Nanette



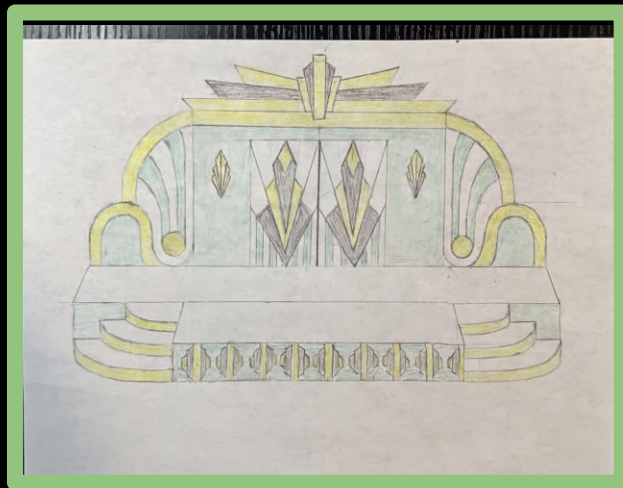
Director: Joshua Denning
Lighting Designer: Robert Wise
Scenic Painter: Ewa Brinker



Scenic Designer for HSPVA's
2024 Spring Mainstage:
No No Nanette

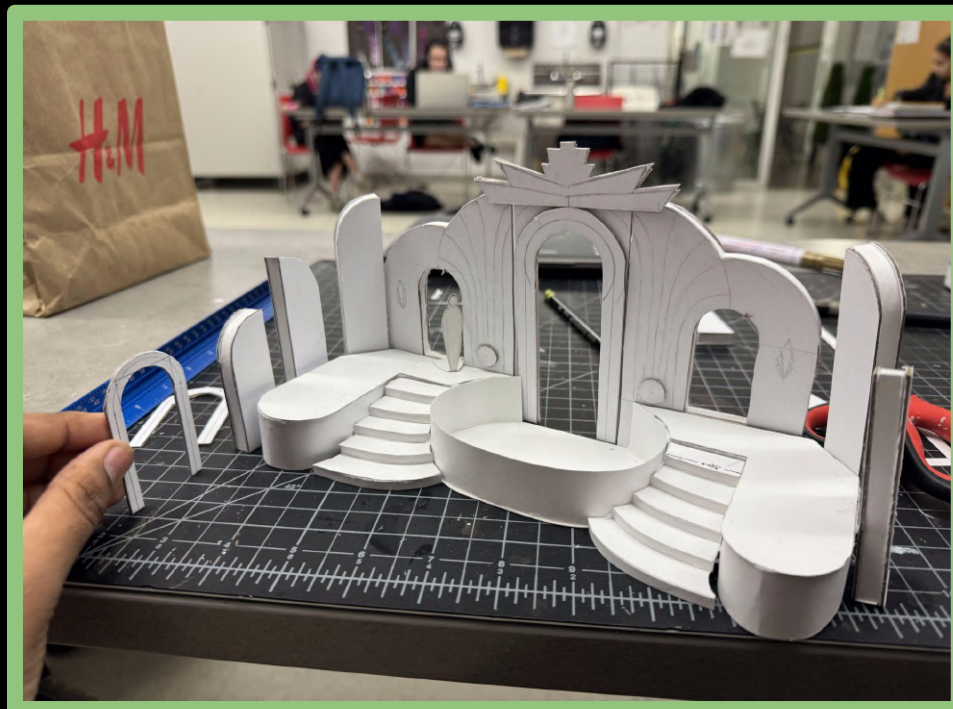


No No Nanette



To the left are my **preliminary** draft and my **updated** design.

I used **AutoCAD** by Autodesk to computer draft the **elevation view** of my design.



I used **paper, bristol board, and Sobo** to create a **3D model** of my design. This model served as a basis for **understanding the space** and for **future design alterations**.

My final **3D model** was painted using **gouache** and represents many hours of work toward realizing my **final design**.



No No Nanette



I had to construct the set around **two baby grand pianos** at center stage, so I designed **stairs** on either side to highlight and **accentuate** their presence

To design the flats, I used **arcs**, providing a more **organic** look to the set design while still having **bold lines**. This is reminiscent of 1920's **art deco** architecture.



I used **bright colors** representing the setting to draw **attention** to the **frivolous** events in the show while also created a **vibrant atmosphere**.

No No Nanette

One of the most **challenging** aspects of the design involved the construction of the **stairs**. They had to be precisely **jigsawed** due to their **organic** shape.



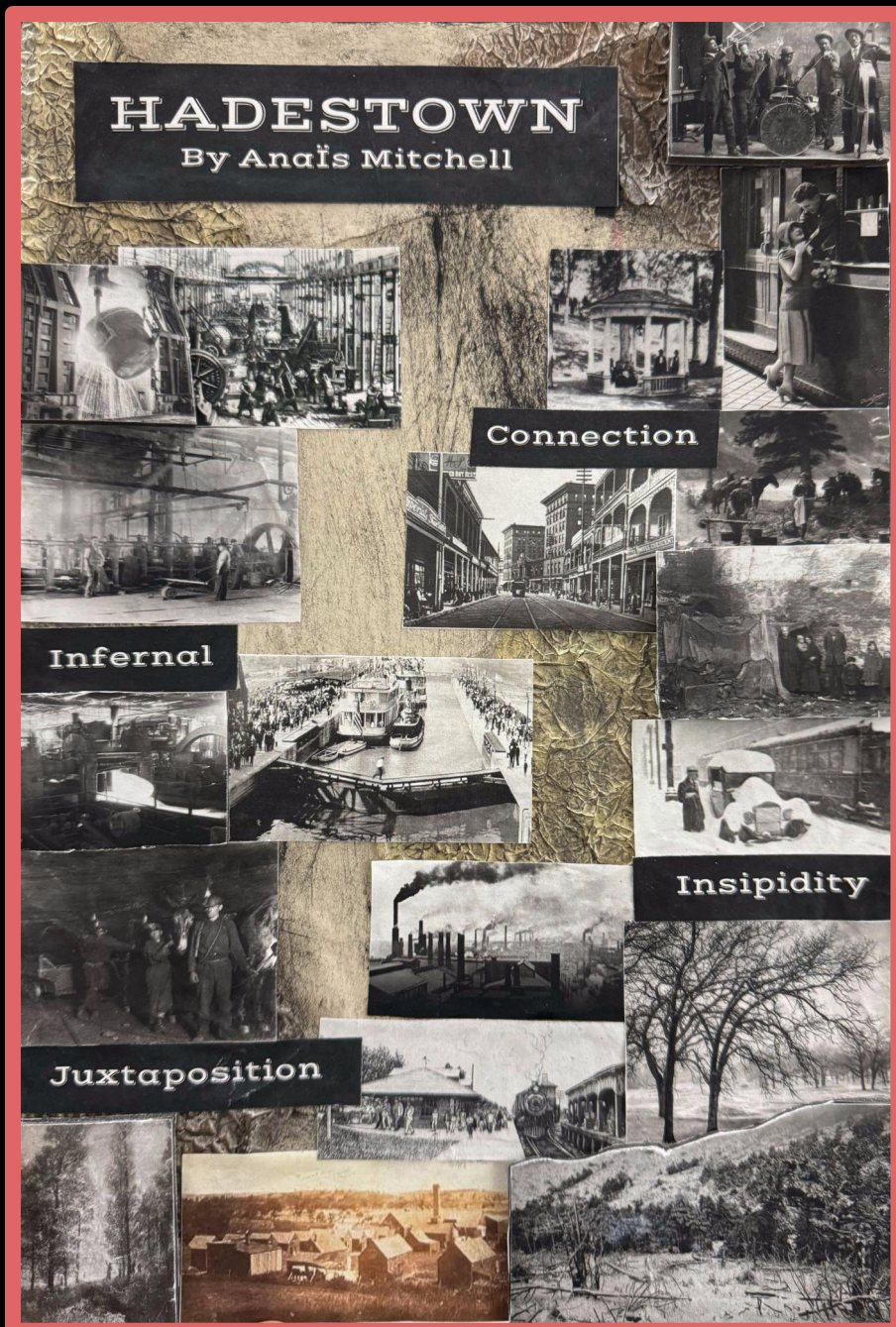
Constructing the set with space for **two baby grand pianos** required me to think about the **entrance/exit** for the pianists, **space** for the pianists to walk around, and the **safety** of the actors on the stairs.



The many **decorative arches** served as a way to **frame** the **colorful** set against the black curtains behind them.



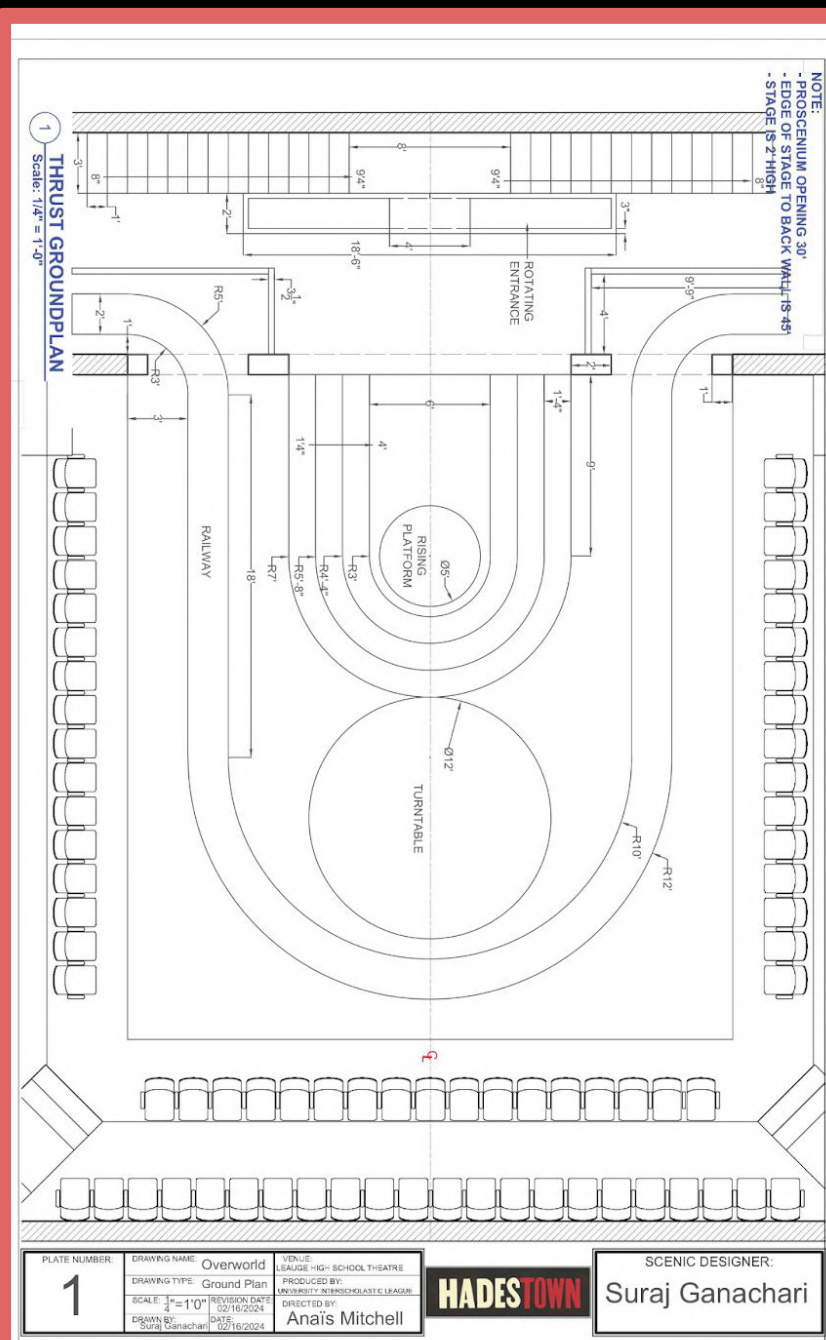
UIL Design



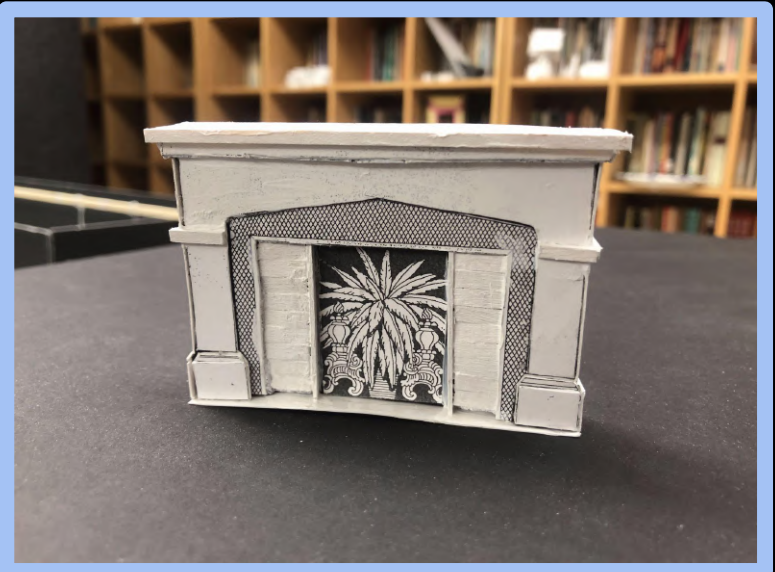
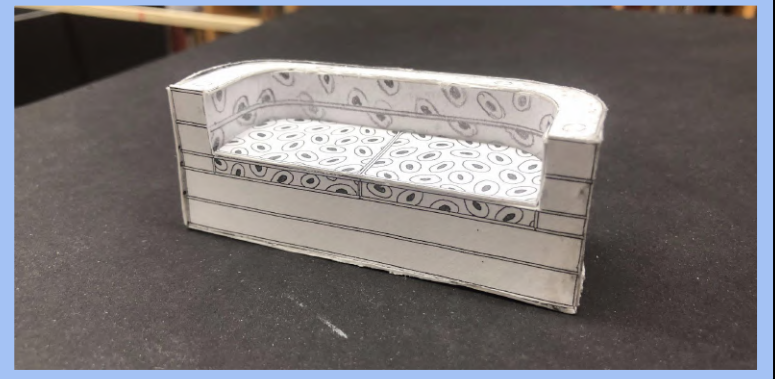
Our design revolved around the **jazz age** in the **1920s** and the **juxtaposition** between the fiery urban **industrialism** and the frigid rural **naturalism**. I used **foam core board** to create a **model** of the set, **bristol board** to make the mini **train models**, and **AutoCAD** for the **ground plan**.



This is my submission to the **UIL Theatrical Design competition** which is a statewide design competition. I was a **scenic designer** for a group submission of **Hadestown**.

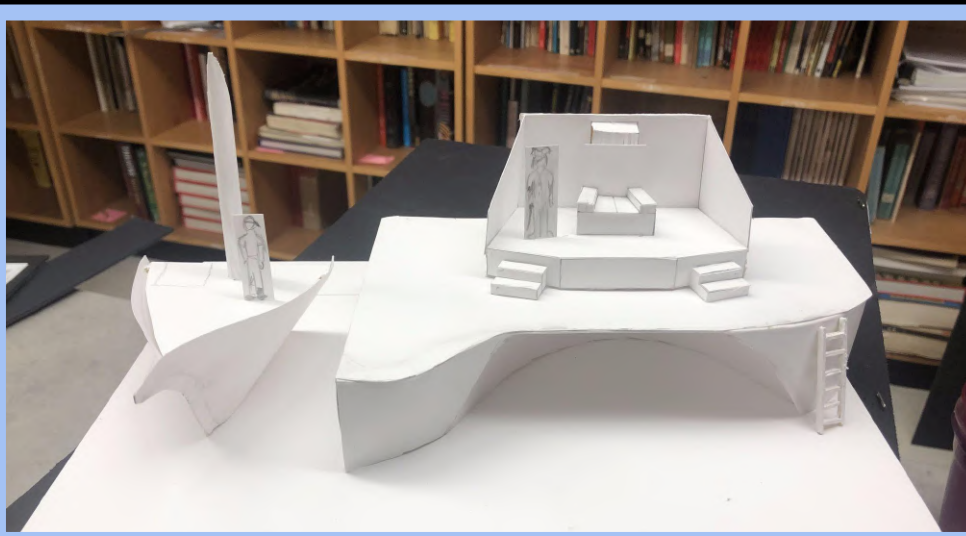


Model Making & Projections



I used **paper, bristol board, and scale lumber** to create **scale model** of furniture items. I also used **foam core board** and tissue paper to create a **model doorway**.

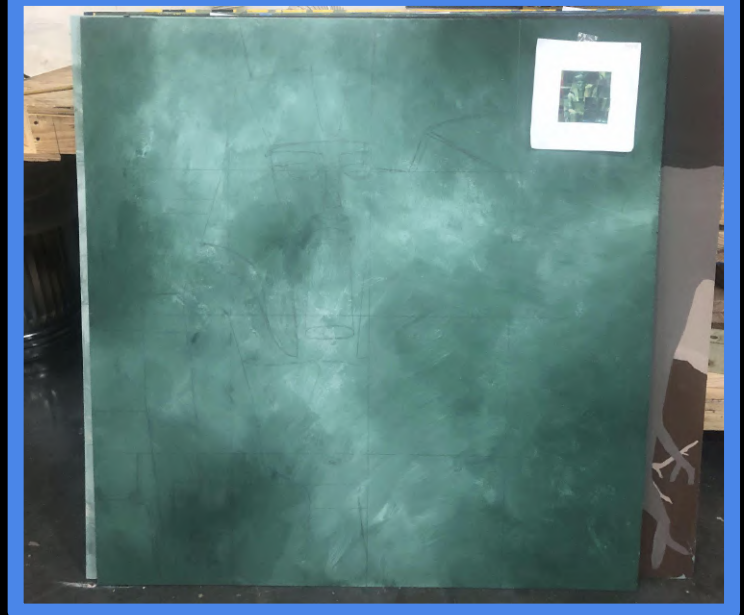
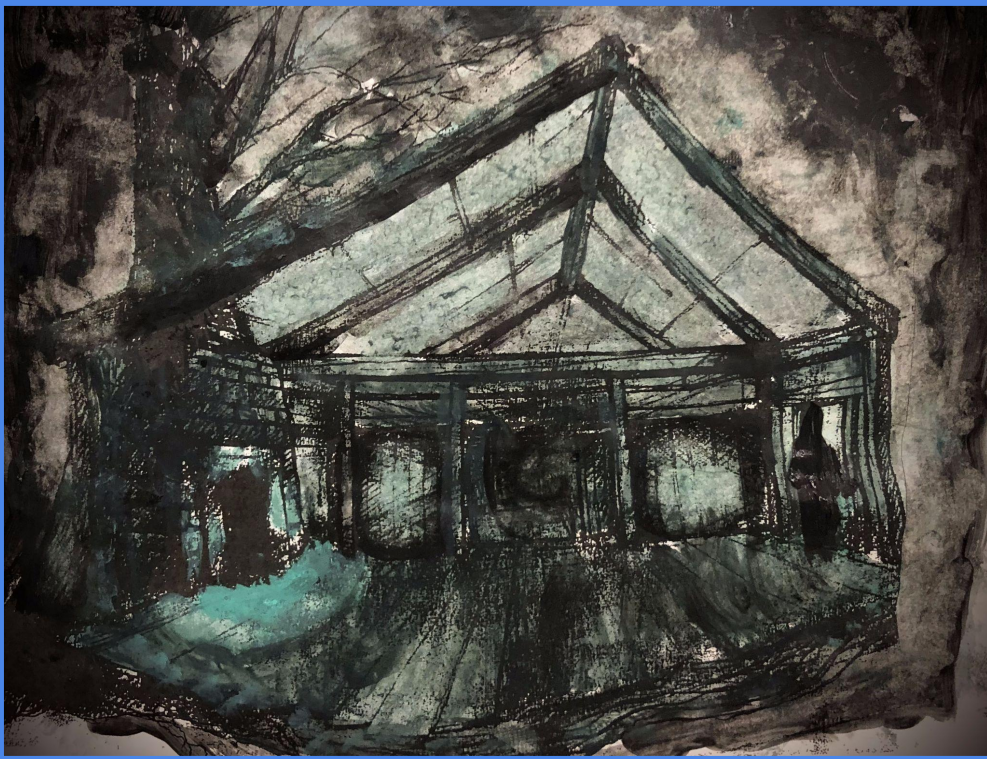
I also created a **set design** for Shakespeare's **The Tempest**.



In our **projections class**, our group combined elements of our model for **The Tempest** to texture with light. We used a projector and **masked** out elements in **QLab** to bring **texture and color** to our set.



Scenic Painting & Color Theory



These are examples of **scenic painting** where I applied **scumbling** techniques as well as practicing with **tints, tones, and shades**. I also used color to create a **spooky** atmosphere.



Below are examples of a **chromatic black** exercise along with a class **color wall** where we could compare colors and how we made them.

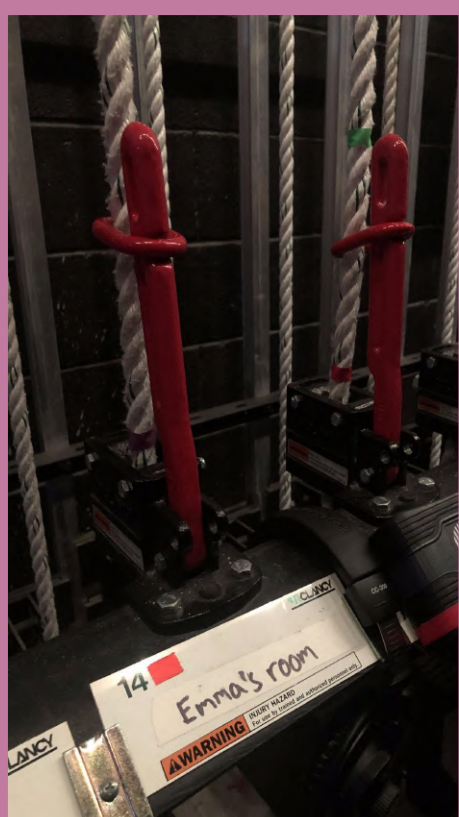


The Prom

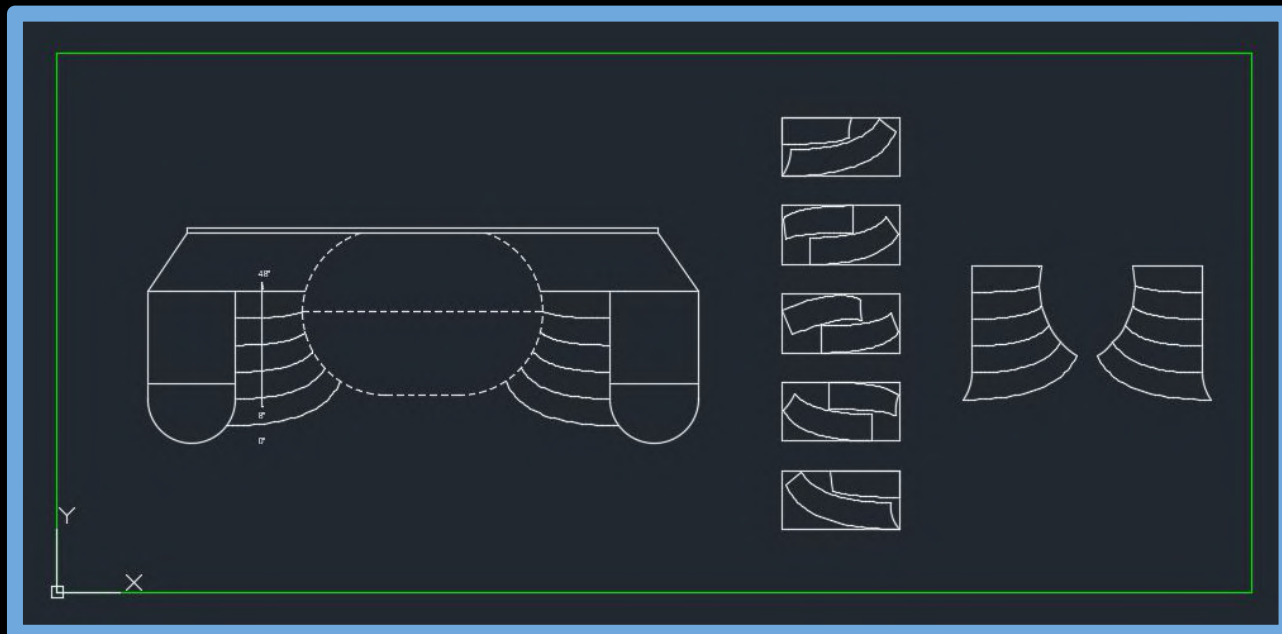


Director:
Rozanne Curtis
**Scenic
Designers:**
Anfisa Maredia
and Faina
Maredia
Rail Crew: Ben
Kiloran

I was part of the rail crew for HSPVA's 2023 Fall All-School Musical **The Prom**. I was in charge of operating the **counterweight fly system** during the performance and ensuring the **proper functionality** of all the pieces.

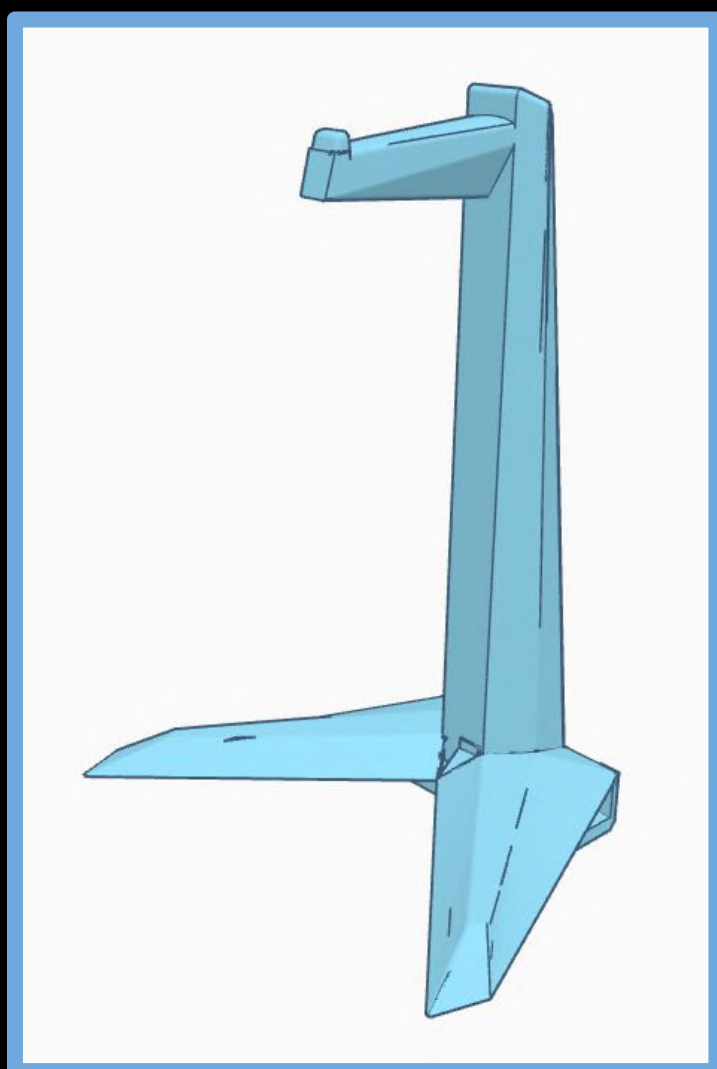
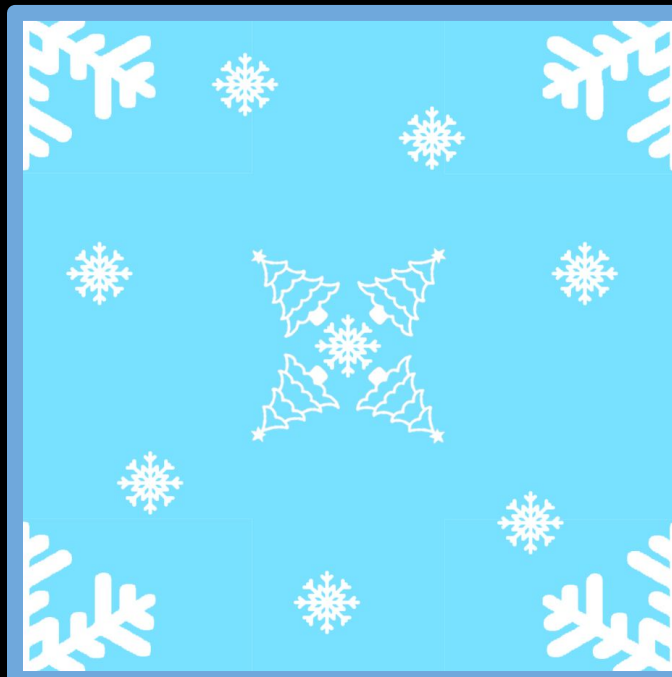


Software Usage

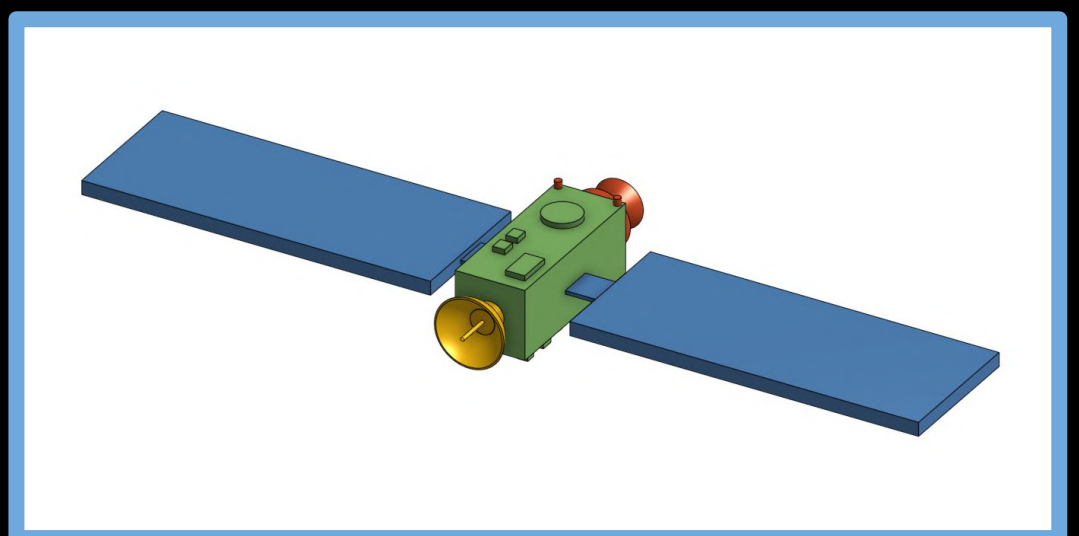


To the left is an example of my skills of **computer drafting** using Autodesk's **AutoCAD** software for **No No Nanette**.

To the right are examples of my **Photoshop** skills. I created a **zombie** using many different **layers**, and a **pattern** that repeated for a **wallpaper**.

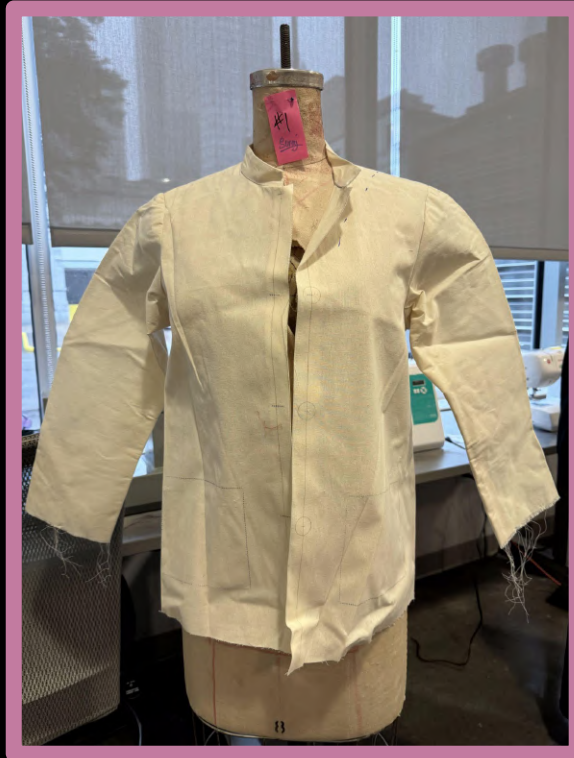


Below are examples of my **digital 3D modeling** skills. I primarily use **Onshape** but have had experience in **Blender** and with **TinkerCAD**. To the left is a **self-designed** headphone stand and to the right of that is a satellite I designed and **modeled**.



Costume Crafts and Alterations

I was able to alter a muslin shirt to **fit the form** of a **mannequin**. I carefully planned my **darts** and used an **industrial sewing machine** to stitch the fabric together.



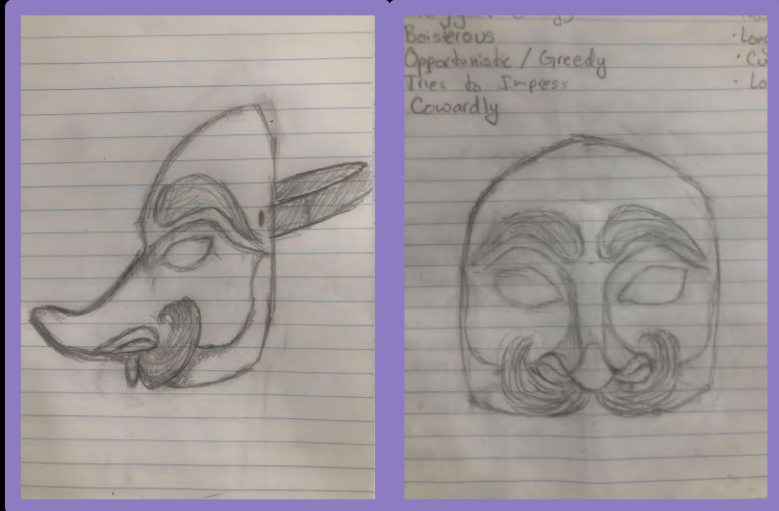
Hat is still in progress and will continue to be improved upon.



Below is my attempt at a **tricorne hat** for the character **Frederic** from **The Pirates of Penzance**. I used **buckram** for the crown and **Fosshape** for the brim. I used **hand stitching** to stitch together the pieces, add wire around the brim, and cover the hat in black and red fabric.



Props



Above is a mask I designed and made based on the **commedia dell'Arte** character, **Il Capitano**. I used **clay** to create a facial structure and **paper mache** and **Sculpt or Coat** to create the actual mask. Then I painted it and added a strap.

Below is a **balustrade** I made as part of a group project. We used a **wooden frame** and **plastic bottles** covered in pantyhose as the posts. We then used **Jaxsan** to provide texture and finally painted it gray.



Design Challenges

I have been a part of **design challenges** where the design majors have a timed competition to put their **skills to the test**.

To the right is my **design and application** of makeup based on **The Woman in Black**. This was my first experience applying makeup.

Application on Simon Martin



To the left is a group costume design based on **King Henry VIII**. For this challenge, we had to use **common household materials** such as paper, plastic, cardboard, tape, and magazines. In our design we tried to incorporate many of the **historical elements** while improvising with the **limited available materials**.